Fidson Healthcare Plc (NGX: FIDSON)

Equity Research Report: Business, Industry, Risk and Financial Model Analysis

Basis of preparation. All figures are in Nigerian naira. Historical figures (FY2023 to FY2025) follow the FY2025 annual report as captured in the team's financial model. Forecasts (FY2026F to FY2029F) are the model's base case unless stated. The model presents a restructured view of the accounts: personnel and depreciation costs are reclassified, EBIT is shown before the net exchange loss and impairment, and all interest-bearing borrowings sit in non-current liabilities. Some ratios therefore differ from those computed directly on the audited statements, and the differences are flagged where they matter. Fidson's earlier unaudited FY2025 announcement showed profit after tax of ₦9.31bn (up 61.1% on ₦5.78bn) and a net exchange loss of ₦5.51bn. This report uses the figures in the model: profit after tax of ₦9.88bn, a 2024 comparative of ₦4.40bn and a net exchange loss of ₦6.01bn. This version does not include a valuation, so it gives no rating or target price.

1. Executive Summary

Fidson Healthcare Plc is a Nigerian pharmaceutical manufacturer with a portfolio spanning ethical (prescription) products, over-the-counter (OTC) medicines and consumer healthcare or toll-manufactured products. Revenue was ₦119.06bn in FY2025, up from ₦84.19bn in FY2024. Ethical products contribute about 65% of revenue, and about 99.6% of revenue is earned in Nigeria.

Operating performance has been strong. Revenue grew 58.7% in 2024 and 41.4% in 2025, and net profit rose from ₦4.40bn to ₦9.88bn (up 125%), lifting return on equity to about 33%. Profit conversion remains thin, however. The EBITDA margin was 25.5% in FY2025 but the net margin was only 8.3%, because the net exchange loss (₦6.01bn) and finance costs (₦7.13bn) both sit below EBIT.

The team's base-case model projects revenue rising from ₦119.06bn in FY2025 to ₦383.44bn by FY2029F, about 34% a year, with growth easing from 43.6% in FY2026F to 25% in FY2029F. The model does not assume margin expansion. The gross margin is held at 44.6% and the EBITDA margin at 23.4%, below the 25.5% achieved in FY2025. Net profit is projected to rise from ₦14.65bn in FY2026F to ₦40.53bn in FY2029F, and the net margin improves from 8.6% to 10.6%. That improvement comes mainly from holding the net exchange loss and impairment flat in naira terms while finance costs grow more slowly than revenue.

Growth is working-capital hungry. The model shows a ₦23.7bn working-capital outflow in FY2026F and negative operating cash flow of ₦6.0bn that year, turning positive from FY2027F. Expansion and dividends are partly funded by borrowing: funded debt (borrowings, other financial liabilities and overdraft) rises from ₦33.7bn to ₦59.3bn, although net debt to EBITDA, after rising to 1.07x in FY2026F, falls from 0.95x in FY2025 to 0.64x by FY2029F as earnings grow. The current ratio moves from 1.6x to 2.0x on the model's classification, which is about 1.2x for FY2025 on the audited classification.

Outcomes are very sensitive to margins. Across the model's three scenarios, FY2029F revenue ranges from ₦329bn to ₦444bn and net profit from ₦4.4bn to ₦84.0bn. In the worst case, interest cover falls to about 1.7x, operating cash flow stays negative and the overdraft reaches ₦53bn by FY2029F.

The operating environment remains difficult. Fidson is exposed to foreign exchange volatility, inflation, high energy and logistics costs, imported inputs and a revenue base concentrated in Nigeria. From an ESG perspective the company benefits from the social relevance of local medicine manufacturing and maintains formal governance structures, but quantitative ESG disclosure is limited and the 2025 CEO succession needs monitoring.

Overall, Fidson presents an attractive growth story supported by local manufacturing capability and favourable industry policy. The investment case depends less on top-line growth than on whether margins hold and whether growth converts into cash. Valuation work is still required before a rating can be given (see Section 10).

2. Business Description

2.1 Company Background

Fidson Healthcare Plc is a Nigerian pharmaceutical manufacturing and healthcare company engaged principally in the **manufacture and distribution of pharmaceutical products**. It was incorporated as a private limited liability company on **13 March 1995** and listed on the Nigerian Stock Exchange on **5 June 2008**.

The business began as a local distributor of pharmaceutical products in 1995, moved into importing its own branded finished medicines within its first year, and opened its first local manufacturing facility at **Sango-Ota, Ogun State, in 2002**. According to the company's profile, it became the first company in sub-Saharan Africa to manufacture antiretroviral drugs in 2005. It invested about **₦10 billion** in a new formulation plant completed in 2016, with full operations from 2017, which more than doubled previous capacity and added eye and ear drops, intravenous fluids, tablets, capsules, liquids, creams and ointments, and dry powders.

Fidson is headquartered in **Lagos**, and its major manufacturing operations are in **Ota, Ogun State**.

2.2 Major Products

Fidson's 2025 corporate profile cites **more than 350 products and formulations** across antibiotics, anti-malarials, parenterals, anti-diabetics, haematinics, neuropsychiatric products, herbal and nutraceutical products, antiretrovirals, osteo-care, cardiovascular medicines, analgesics and gastrointestinal products.

Product / Therapeutic Area	**Examples / Description**
Anti-infectives / Antibiotics	Ciprotab, Metrone, ciprofloxacin and other antibacterial preparations
Anti-malaria	Arthemed and Emal
Cardiovascular	Products such as Avstat (atorvastatin)
Anti-diabetic / Metabolic	Medicines for diabetes and related metabolic conditions
Gastrointestinal	Products for digestive conditions

Product / Therapeutic Area	Examples / Description
Analgesics / Pain management	Pain-relief and anti-inflammatory products
Haematinics & Supplements	Astyfer, Cestra and other nutritional products
Ophthalmic / Eye-care	Antibiotic and other ophthalmic preparations
Parenteral products	Intravenous fluids and injectable medicines
Herbal & Nutraceutical	Health and nutritional products
Other	CNS/neuropsychiatry, dermatology, osteo-care and other specialised categories

The portfolio continues to develop. In 2025 Fidson added products such as **Endotone**, and in April 2026 its Aventra proVision business introduced **Atropine 1% w/v Eye Drops**. The manufacturing platform supports tablets, capsules, oral liquids, creams and ointments, dry powders, eye and ear drops, intravenous fluids and injectables, so the company serves both prescription and non-prescription markets.

2.3 Business Segments

Fidson's 2025 Annual Report states that, for financial reporting purposes, the company has a **single reportable segment** because it deals in a range of pharmaceutical products. Revenue is nevertheless analysed across three principal categories.

Ethical Products are prescription-only medicines, including infusions, capsules, tablets and injectables, with revenue recognised on delivery. This is the largest stream at about **₦77.84bn** in FY2025 (₦55.00bn in 2024), roughly 65% of revenue.

Over-the-Counter (OTC) Products are medicines sold without a prescription, including tablets, capsules, syrups and herbal products. They generated **₦36.37bn** in FY2025 (₦26.38bn in 2024), roughly 31% of revenue.

Consumer Healthcare / Toll Manufacturing means Fidson manufactures pharmaceutical products on behalf of other customers, with revenue recognised over the period in which the performance obligation is met. It generated **₦4.33bn** in FY2025 (₦2.80bn in 2024).

2.4 Market and Customer Base

Fidson's primary market is **Nigeria**. Its customers include government healthcare facilities, private hospitals, pharmaceutical distributors, retail pharmacies and healthcare professionals. A distributors' conference held in July 2025 underlined the importance of the distributor network. The commercial model runs: Fidson manufacturing → distributors → pharmacies, hospitals and institutions → patients and consumers.

2.5 Domestic and Export Markets

In FY2025, revenue earned in Nigeria was ₦118.54bn and revenue earned outside Nigeria was ₦523.14m, out of total revenue of ₦119.06bn. About 99.6% of revenue therefore came from Nigeria

and exports were about 0.4%. Fidson is best described as **a primarily Nigerian pharmaceutical manufacturer with an emerging export component that offers potential geographic diversification**, not as an established West African exporter.

2.6 Current Revenue Structure

Category	FY2025 Revenue	Approx. Share
Ethical Products	₦77.84bn	65.4%
OTC Products	₦36.37bn	30.5%
Consumer Healthcare / Toll Manufacturing	₦4.33bn	3.6%
Export	₦0.52bn	0.4%
Total	**₦119.06bn**	**100%**

Source: Fidson Healthcare Plc 2025 Annual Report. Shares are rounded.

Ethical and OTC products together make up about 96% of revenue, so Fidson's performance is closely tied to demand and operating conditions in the Nigerian pharmaceutical market. Exports and toll manufacturing are the main routes to diversification.

3. Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) Analysis

ESG analysis extends traditional financial analysis to non-financial factors that can affect operating performance, regulatory exposure and long-term shareholder value. For a pharmaceutical manufacturer these factors are especially relevant because operations directly affect public health and involve the manufacture, storage, distribution and disposal of medicines. Fidson's Ota facility has been described by the company as World Health Organization (WHO) compliant.

3.1 Environmental

Waste and pharmaceutical disposal. Pharmaceutical companies are responsible for the disposal of expired, defective or unused medicines, because improper disposal can contaminate water systems. Fidson's patient information shows awareness of this: for example, the leaflet for Ultracoal 250 advises consumers not to dispose of unused medicines through wastewater or household waste. For an investor, the open question is whether the same principles are applied systematically across manufacturing and distribution.

Energy and carbon. Pharmaceutical production requires substantial energy for production, refrigeration, ventilation, sterilisation and laboratories. In Nigeria, unreliable grid supply means manufacturers often depend on generators. Fidson's factory energy cost rose from about ₦4.30bn in 2024 to ₦5.12bn in 2025, so efficiency measures such as energy-efficient equipment, solar solutions, efficient HVAC and lighting, energy monitoring and emissions measurement could deliver both environmental and financial benefits.

Water. Water is an input to production and cleaning, and wastewater must be managed responsibly. Investors should look for measurable targets on water consumption, recycling, wastewater treatment, water intensity per unit of output and water-related incidents.

Disclosure gap. A stronger framework would publish tonnes of hazardous and non-hazardous waste, the share recycled, wastewater treated, energy per unit produced, greenhouse-gas emissions, water consumption and any environmental incidents or breaches.

3.2 Social

Access to medicines and product quality. Fidson's core business contributes directly to healthcare access through domestic manufacturing of antibiotics, anti-malarials, antiretrovirals, parenterals and other essential categories. Product quality and patient safety are the most material social issues for the company, because a quality failure harms patients and can lead to recalls, regulatory action and lost revenue.

Employees and workplace. The company has received recognition from NECA and the Nigerian Health Excellence Awards, which provides some external evidence of its standing as an employer and healthcare company. Quantified workforce indicators (headcount, turnover, workplace safety incidents, training hours and diversity) were not found in the materials reviewed, so employee welfare cannot yet be assessed against measurable targets.

Community. Educational and youth-focused initiatives point to investment in community development, but the scale and cost of these programmes should be confirmed from the Annual Report before they are relied upon.

What to monitor. Investors should watch product recalls and pharmacovigilance reports, workplace safety data, supply continuity of essential medicines and the pricing of essential products, given the affordability risk discussed in Section 7.

3.3 Governance

Governance matters for any listed company because investors rely on the board and management to protect shareholder interests, maintain financial integrity and manage risk, and Fidson operates in a highly regulated sector.

Board and audit. Fidson maintains a formal governance framework and publishes governance information. The 2025 Audit Committee comprised both directors and shareholder representatives, which strengthens accountability by giving shareholders a direct role in oversight. Deloitte & Touche served as external auditor. An audit opinion provides assurance over the financial statements but not over ESG metrics.

Risk management and internal controls. The company faces regulatory, product liability, foreign-exchange, interest-rate, supply-chain, cybersecurity, reputational, credit and operational risks. The key question is whether management has systems to identify, quantify, monitor and mitigate them, and weak financial governance would raise the cost of capital.

Leadership transition. In 2025 the long-serving Managing Director and CEO, Dr. Fidelis Ayebae, stepped down after about 30 years with the company, and Mr. Biola Adebayo took over. The risk is uncertainty

over strategic direction, relationships, execution of growth plans and culture. The opportunity is fresh strategic thinking, operational improvement and more institutionalised management processes. The effect should be judged by whether revenue growth, profitability, capital discipline and cash generation are maintained.

3.4 Ethics and Compliance

Marketing and promotion must be truthful, scientifically supported, compliant, transparent about risks and free from misleading claims. **Anti-bribery and corruption** controls matter because the company deals with government agencies, hospitals, healthcare professionals, distributors and procurement bodies. They should cover bribery, facilitation payments, conflicts of interest, gifts and entertainment, political contributions, procurement integrity and whistleblowing. **Regulatory compliance** covers manufacturing standards, product registration, quality assurance, labelling, pharmacovigilance, recalls, advertising, and environmental and employment rules, and the WHO-compliant facility is strategically significant as a value-protection mechanism. **Data privacy and cybersecurity** are emerging governance issues because Fidson holds information on customers, employees, suppliers, healthcare professionals and its manufacturing systems.

3.5 ESG Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths	**Weaknesses / Areas for improvement**
Strong social relevance through domestic medicine manufacturing	Limited quantitative ESG disclosure (emissions, energy, water, waste)
WHO-compliant manufacturing facility supporting quality and scalability	Few published ESG targets (emissions, waste, energy, diversity)
Product information shows attention to safety and appropriate use	No independent assurance of ESG metrics
Formal governance, including a mixed director and shareholder Audit Committee	Succession risk following the 2025 CEO transition
External recognition (NECA, Nigerian Health Excellence Awards)	Supply-chain exposure to imported inputs, logistics and FX
Educational and youth community initiatives	Social metrics (workforce, safety, community spend) not quantified

3.6 Overall ESG Assessment

Fidson's ESG profile broadly supports the long-term investment case, particularly on the social and governance dimensions. Disclosure is the main weakness, especially quantified environmental metrics and measurable targets. The most material ESG risks are product quality, regulatory compliance, supply-chain resilience, ethical conduct and management succession, and these should feed into the financial model through revenue growth, operating margins, capital expenditure, working capital and the cost of capital.

4. Industry Overview and Competitive Landscape

4.1 Industry Overview

Fidson operates in Nigeria's pharmaceutical manufacturing and healthcare industry, with activities spanning ethical medicines, OTC products, consumer healthcare and exports. Demand is structural, driven by population growth, rising healthcare needs and the burden of both infectious and non-communicable diseases.

A major trend is the push for local manufacturing. NAFDAC's 2024 to 2027 strategic plan targets raising the share of medicines manufactured locally to 70% by 2027, which favours established domestic manufacturers. Costs remain a pressure: manufacturers are exposed to exchange rates, imported raw materials, energy, inflation, logistics and regulation, and NAFDAC requires facilities to meet Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) standards.

4.2 Key Market Trends

- **Prescription demand.** Ethical product revenue rose from ₦55.00bn in 2024 to ₦77.84bn in 2025, about 65% of revenue.
- **OTC expansion.** OTC revenue rose from ₦26.38bn to ₦36.37bn.
- **Local manufacturing.** Policy increasingly favours domestic production, which benefits Fidson's established infrastructure and range of dosage forms.
- **Exports.** Export revenue rose from essentially zero in 2024 to ₦523m in 2025 and about ₦1.82bn in Q1 2026, an early but fast-growing business.
- **Contract manufacturing.** Fidson has previously entered manufacturing relationships with international companies including GSK and Bayer, which strengthened its technical capability.
- **Cost pressure.** Factory energy costs rose from about ₦4.30bn in 2024 to ₦5.12bn in 2025.

4.3 Competitive Landscape

Fidson competes with domestic manufacturers, multinationals, importers and distributors. Key domestic competitors include May & Baker Nigeria Plc, Neimeth International Pharmaceuticals Plc, MeCure Industries Plc, Emzor Pharmaceutical Industries and Swiss Pharma Nigeria (Swipha). Multinationals tend to have advantages in global brands, R&D and specialised products, while Nigerian manufacturers compete through local production, pricing, distribution reach, regulatory knowledge and understanding of local consumers.

Fidson appears well positioned among domestic manufacturers because of its scale and breadth. FY2025 revenue of ₦119.06bn was up 41.4% on ₦84.19bn. Its 2024 annual report describes 350+ NAFDAC-registered brands across prescription and OTC categories and ten dosage forms at its WHO cGMP-certifiable facility in Ota. A quantified peer comparison (revenue, margins, leverage and valuation multiples) would strengthen this section and is recommended before the report is finalised.

5. Macroeconomic and Regulatory Environment

Causal chain: naira depreciation → higher imported input costs → FX losses and margin pressure → slower earnings growth → valuation sensitivity to FX policy.

1. Currency risk, the dominant macro variable. Naira depreciation raises the cost of imported raw materials. Fidson's net exchange loss was ₦6.01bn in FY2025, ₦5.45bn in 2024 and ₦1.26bn in 2023 (reportedly among the largest of the listed Nigerian pharmaceutical companies in 2024). Industry estimates of the imported share of pharmaceutical raw materials range from roughly 70% to 80% up to more than 90%. The business impact is rising landed input costs, the financial impact is FX losses below the operating line and strain on working capital, and the valuation impact is that FX losses should be treated as recurring, not one-off, when normalising earnings.

2. Earnings kept growing anyway. FY2025 revenue rose 41.4% to ₦119.06bn and profit after tax rose 125% to ₦9.88bn, while Q1 2026 revenue grew 21.7% and profit rose 40.3%. Pricing power appears to have let Fidson pass through cost inflation faster than the naira depreciated. That is the strongest evidence for a premium multiple, but it raises sustainability questions if depreciation accelerates or affordability limits bind (see Section 7.2).

3. Rising costs beyond FX. Selling, distribution and administrative expenses have risen with inflation, logistics and personnel costs. H1 2026 finance costs reached ₦2.91bn, reflecting Nigeria's high-rate environment, and healthcare inflation hit 30.35% in early 2026, above general inflation. Cost pressure now extends to domestic logistics, wages and borrowing, so the model should be sensitised to the policy-rate path as well as FX.

4. Regulation and local manufacturing policy. NAFDAC's "5+5" import-substitution policy has pushed over 70% of affected products to local manufacturing, with a roadmap targeting 70% local production capacity by 2027. NAFDAC has also tightened oversight through the Pharmaceutical Products Traceability Regulations 2024, the Paediatric Regulation 2024 and the Greenbook verification tool, and the Nigeria Tax Act 2025 (effective January 2026) introduced new VAT and e-invoicing compliance requirements. Import substitution is a tailwind for Fidson's local-manufacturing strategy and reduces licensing risk relative to import-dependent peers, although compliance and traceability add near-term cost.

6. Financial Analysis (FY2023 to FY2025)

Fidson's operating performance strengthened steadily over FY2023 to FY2025. Revenue grew from ₦53.1bn to ₦119.1bn and the EBITDA margin expanded from 20% to 25%. The net profit margin did not follow, staying in a volatile 5% to 8% band. The gap is explained almost entirely by items below EBIT, namely the net exchange loss and finance costs, which have grown faster and more erratically than the operating business.

6.1 Financial Summary

₦'000	2023	2024	2025
Revenue	53,050,354	84,189,000	119,061,254
Gross Profit	23,449,564	38,099,575	52,764,485
EBITDA	10,752,033	20,552,241	30,332,592
EBIT	9,485,296	18,884,591	28,093,748

₦'000	2023	2024	2025
Net FX Loss	1,261,246	5,448,891	6,012,067
Finance Cost	2,101,868	5,493,822	7,130,319
Profit Before Tax	5,917,409	7,700,460	14,962,608
Taxation	2,309,816	3,301,497	5,079,032
Profit for the Year	3,607,593	4,398,963	9,883,576

Gross profit and EBIT are on the model's restructured basis, which moves personnel costs out of cost of sales and separates depreciation. On the audited basis, FY2025 gross profit was ₦49.23bn (a 41.3% margin) and operating profit was ₦21.95bn. The model's EBIT of ₦28.09bn is stated before the net exchange loss (₦6.01bn) and impairment of receivables (₦0.13bn), which together account for the difference.

6.2 Margin and Ratio Trend

Metric	2023	2024	2025
Revenue growth	31%	59%	41%
Gross profit margin	44%	45%	44%
EBITDA margin	20%	24%	25%
Net profit margin	7%	5%	8%
Effective tax rate	39.0%	42.9%	33.9%
Return on equity	19%	20%	33%
Return on assets	6%	6%	12%
Interest coverage (EBIT / finance cost)	4.5x	3.4x	3.9x
Current ratio (model classification)	1.8x	1.6x	1.6x
Cash ratio	0.3x	0.1x	0.1x

Interest coverage on audited operating profit was about 3.1x in FY2025. The current ratio on the audited classification was about 1.2x in each year, because the model presents all borrowings as non-current. The full balance sheet for FY2023 to FY2029F is in Section 8.3.

Gross margin has been essentially flat at 44% to 45%, and the EBITDA margin has expanded through operating leverage. The net margin fell in 2024 before recovering in 2025 because FX losses and finance costs, not the operating cost base, drive the swings below EBIT.

6.3 Working Capital and Cash Conversion Cycle

Metric	2023	2024	2025
Inventory days	201.7	191.6	146.2
Receivable days	37.4	24.1	33.2
Payable days	86.9	67.9	24.5
Cash conversion cycle (days)	**152.2**	**147.8**	**154.9**

- **Inventory days** improved from 201.7 to 146.2. Less stock is being held per naira of cost of sales, which is a genuine efficiency gain consistent with the rising asset turnover below.
- **Receivable days** fell to 24.1 in 2024 and then rose to 33.2 in 2025, while trade receivables almost doubled from ₦5.56bn to ₦10.82bn. This reversal should be investigated, because it could reflect a large year-end sale, changed credit terms or early collection slippage.
- **Payable days** fell from 86.9 to 67.9 to 24.5, the most significant working-capital shift. Fidson is paying suppliers much faster, so cash is tied up at both ends of the cycle.
- **Net effect.** The cash conversion cycle has not improved (152.2, 147.8, then 154.9 days): the inventory gain was offset by faster supplier payment and slower collection. The forecast should not assume that inventory efficiency alone will keep freeing up cash.

The model does not extrapolate these trends. In FY2026F it resets working capital to three-year average ratios, which means about 180 inventory days (146 in FY2025) and about 60 payable days (24.5 in FY2025). That reset drives the ₦23.7bn working-capital outflow discussed in Section 8.

6.4 Margin Notes

- **Gross margin (44.2%, 45.3%, 44.3%)** stayed within a 1.1 percentage-point band while revenue more than doubled, which suggests stable cost-of-sales pass-through. It is a good candidate for a fixed base-case assumption with a narrow sensitivity band.
- **EBITDA margin (20.3%, 24.4%, 25.5%)** shows genuine operating leverage. Selling and distribution costs fell from 10.5% to 8.1% of revenue and administrative expenses from 14.4% to 11.5%. Two years of data is a short trend, and the drivers (one-off efficiencies or structural fixed-cost absorption) need evidence. The model uses three-year average cost ratios (9.4% and 12.6%), which gives back part of that gain and is why forecast EBITDA margin (23.4%) sits below FY2025.
- **Net margin (6.8%, 5.2%, 8.3%)** is the least stable line. It is a residual after two volatile, largely non-operating items (FX losses and finance costs) and a swinging effective tax rate, so it should be built up from EBITDA margin less each below-the-line item rather than modelled as a fixed percentage of revenue.
- **The spread between EBITDA margin and net margin** widened from 13.5 points in 2023 to 19.2 points in 2024 and narrowed to 17.2 points in 2025. It is effectively one combined measure of FX loss, finance cost and tax drag, and is a useful early-warning indicator.

6.5 Ratio Notes

- **Return on equity (18.7%, 19.7%, 32.7%) and return on assets (5.8%, 6.0%, 12.3%)** jumped in 2025, driven by the 125% rise in net profit rather than a change in the equity or asset base. Because net profit is volatile, 2025 should be treated as a high point, not a new baseline.
- **Asset turnover (0.9x, 1.1x, 1.5x)** improved steadily and more consistently than the return ratios, which points to a structural gain in working-capital efficiency and capacity utilisation, probably at a decelerating rate.
- **Interest coverage (4.5x, 3.4x, 3.9x)** dipped in 2024 when finance costs more than doubled and partly recovered in 2025. Coverage above 3x is generally adequate, but the 2024 dip shows how quickly it can compress, so it should be stress-tested against the finance-cost scenarios in Section 8.6.
- **Current ratio and cash ratio** declined and then plateaued with little headroom. Liquidity is a function of working-capital timing more than cash on hand, which constrains how much stress the FX and finance-cost scenarios can absorb.

7. Risk Analysis

Fidson operates in an industry with strong underlying demand, supported by Nigeria's healthcare needs and the push towards local manufacturing. The key question for investors is whether it can keep growing revenue and profit while managing FX pressure, imported input costs, rising operating expenses and regulation.

7.1 Foreign Exchange and Imported Input Risk

Nigeria's pharmaceutical industry depends heavily on imported active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) and excipients, with industry estimates of the imported share ranging from roughly 70% to over 90%. Naira depreciation raises the cost of all of these. Fidson recorded a net exchange loss of **₦6.01bn in FY2025**, after ₦5.45bn in 2024 and ₦1.26bn in 2023.

The company has offset part of the pressure through higher selling prices. Revenue rose 41.4% to ₦119.06bn in FY2025 and profit after tax rose 125% to ₦9.88bn, which suggests a significant share of higher costs was passed on. Further depreciation could squeeze margins if input costs rise faster than prices. Local manufacturing capacity and supportive government policy provide some protection.

7.2 Pricing and Consumer Affordability Risk

Recent growth has been supported by price increases in response to inflation and higher input costs. Continued increases could eventually dent demand if medicines become less affordable, which matters because about 99.6% of FY2025 revenue came from Nigeria. If household purchasing power weakens, consumers may switch to cheaper alternatives or delay purchases, and institutional buyers and distributors may become more price sensitive. A broad portfolio across ethical, OTC and consumer healthcare products provides some protection. The key risk is a point at which further price rises weaken volume growth while input costs keep climbing.

7.3 Supply Chain and Raw Material Risk

Manufacturing depends on reliable access to imported raw materials. Shortages, logistics disruption or limited access to foreign currency could cut production volumes and force higher inventory holdings, which ties up more cash. Local manufacturing gives Fidson more control than companies dependent on imported finished products. In the model, a downside case should combine lower volumes, higher cost of sales and greater working-capital needs.

7.4 Regulatory and Product Quality Risk

Fidson must maintain compliance across manufacturing standards, registration, quality assurance, labelling, pharmacovigilance, advertising and recalls. A serious failure could lead to product suspension, recall or restrictions on manufacturing, and damage the company's reputation. The Ota facility is described as WHO-compliant, while corporate reporting also describes it as WHO cGMP-certifiable. A major issue would reduce revenue through lost sales, add recall and remediation costs, and could raise the perceived risk of the company.

7.5 Operating Cost and Inflation Risk

Costs are rising across energy, logistics and personnel. Factory energy cost increased from about ₦4.30bn in 2024 to ₦5.12bn in 2025, and selling, distribution and administrative expenses have risen with inflation. If costs outpace revenue, margins will come under pressure, and the risk is greater when combined with affordability limits on pricing.

7.6 Interest Rate and Financing Risk

Nigeria's high interest rates raise financing costs. H1 2026 finance costs were about ₦2.91bn. The model assumes finance cost of about 21.7% of opening debt, which is consistent with FY2025 but leaves little room if rates rise. Strong earnings can reduce reliance on external financing over time, but prolonged high rates would keep the cost of capital elevated.

7.7 Other Risks

- **Geographic concentration.** About ₦118.54bn of ₦119.06bn FY2025 revenue came from Nigeria, so changes in the economy, currency, regulation and purchasing power hit most of the business at once. Exports are a small but growing diversifier.
- **Competition.** May & Baker, Neimeth, MeCure, Emzor and Swipha compete across categories. Fidson's scale, portfolio and distribution are advantages, but stronger competition could reduce pricing power or raise marketing and distribution costs.
- **Leadership succession.** The 2025 change of CEO after about 30 years creates some uncertainty around strategy and continuity. The impact depends on whether the new team maintains growth, profitability and capital discipline.

7.8 Risk Summary

Risk	Probability	Potential impact	Main financial effect
Foreign exchange and imported inputs	High	High	Higher cost of sales, FX losses and lower

Risk	Probability	Potential impact	Main financial effect
			margins
Pricing and affordability	Medium	High	Lower volume and revenue growth
Supply chain and raw materials	Medium	High	Production disruption and higher input costs
Regulatory and product quality	Medium	Very High	Lost revenue, recall costs and reputational damage
Operating costs and inflation	High	High	Lower operating margins
Interest rates and financing	Medium-High	High	Higher finance costs and lower profit after tax
Geographic concentration	Medium	Medium-High	Greater exposure to Nigerian economic conditions
Competition	Medium	Medium	Pressure on pricing and market share
Leadership succession	Low-Medium	Medium	Execution and strategic continuity risk

7.9 Overall Risk Assessment

The strongest risks are foreign exchange exposure, imported input dependence and rising operating costs. Fidson has shown it can grow through these pressures: FY2025 revenue rose 41.4% and profit after tax rose 125%, which is evidence of pricing power and demand resilience. Its sustainability depends on managing further depreciation, controlling production costs and holding demand as prices rise.

Foreign exchange is the most important downside variable because it affects raw material costs, exchange losses and working capital at once. Regulatory and product-quality risk carries the greatest potential severity. The model's worst case (Section 8.6) quantifies the downside: FY2029F net profit of ₦4.4bn against ₦40.5bn in the base case, interest cover of about 1.7x and an overdraft above ₦50bn.

8. Financial Model

This section presents the base-case forecast for FY2026F to FY2029F, built on three years of historical statements (FY2023 to FY2025) in the team's three-statement model (Fidson_v2_final.xlsx). The income statement, balance sheet and cash flow are fully linked, the balance sheet balances in every period, and

a scenario switch moves the model between base, best and worst cases. All tables below are in ₦ billion unless stated.

8.1 Key Base-Case Assumptions

Driver	Base-case assumption
Revenue growth	43.6% in FY2026F (the three-year historical average), then 37%, 31% and 25%
Cost of sales	55.4% of revenue (restructured basis)
Selling and distribution / administrative expenses	9.4% and 12.6% of revenue (three-year averages)
Other operating gains	0.8% of revenue
Depreciation and capital expenditure	PPE depreciation 6.7% of opening PPE; maintainable capex at 1.1x depreciation
Net exchange loss and impairment	Held flat at ₦5.73bn and ₦0.22bn a year
Finance cost / finance income	21.7% of opening debt / 3.8% of opening cash
Tax	38.4% of profit before tax
Working capital	Inventories 27.3% of revenue; trade receivables 8.6% of revenue; prepayments 18.3% and trade payables 16.4% of cost of sales
Dividends	29.8% of profit after tax
Funding	Flat-average new borrowings and repayments; overdraft acts as a cash sweep; minimum cash of ₦2.0bn

8.2 Income Statement, FY2023A to FY2029F

₦bn	2023A	2024A	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
Revenue	53.05	84.19	119.06	170.92	234.16	306.75	383.44
Cost of sales	29.60	46.09	66.30	94.71	129.75	169.97	212.46
Gross profit	**23.45**	**38.10**	**52.76**	**76.22**	**104.42**	**136.79**	**170.98**
Other operating gains	0.50	0.61	0.89	1.37	1.88	2.46	3.08

₦bn	**2023A**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026F**	**2027F**	**2028F**	**2029F**
Selling and distribution	5.55	8.12	9.62	16.06	22.00	28.82	36.03
Administrative expenses	7.64	10.04	13.70	21.56	29.53	38.69	48.36
EBITDA	**10.75**	**20.55**	**30.33**	**39.97**	**54.76**	**71.74**	**89.67**
Depreciation and amortisation	1.27	1.67	2.24	3.12	3.60	4.28	5.25
EBIT (before FX loss and impairment)	**9.49**	**18.88**	**28.09**	**36.85**	**51.16**	**67.46**	**84.42**
Net exchange loss	1.26	5.45	6.01	5.73	5.73	5.73	5.73
Impairment of receivables	0.23	0.30	0.13	0.22	0.22	0.22	0.22
Finance income	0.02	0.06	0.14	0.18	0.08	0.08	0.08
Finance cost	2.10	5.49	7.13	7.29	9.68	11.55	12.73
Profit before tax	**5.92**	**7.70**	**14.96**	**23.79**	**35.60**	**50.03**	**65.81**
Taxation	2.31	3.30	5.08	9.14	13.68	19.22	25.28
Profit for the year	**3.61**	**4.40**	**9.88**	**14.65**	**21.93**	**30.81**	**40.53**
Revenue growth	30.6%	58.7%	41.4%	43.6%	37.0%	31.0%	25.0%

₦bn	**2023A**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026F**	**2027F**	**2028F**	**2029F**
Gross margin	44.2%	45.3%	44.3%	44.6%	44.6%	44.6%	44.6%
EBITDA margin	20.3%	24.4%	25.5%	23.4%	23.4%	23.4%	23.4%
Net margin	6.8%	5.2%	8.3%	8.6%	9.4%	10.0%	10.6%

Revenue roughly triples and net profit grows about four-fold, but margins at EBITDA level are flat to lower. The rise in net margin comes from below EBIT: the exchange loss and impairment are held flat in naira, and finance costs grow more slowly than revenue.

8.3 Balance Sheet, FY2023A to FY2029F

₦bn	2023A	2024A	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
Property, plant and equipment	22.67	25.13	30.94	31.15	31.35	31.56	31.78
Intangibles and other non-current assets	1.03	0.53	0.49	0.59	0.74	0.96	1.27
Total non-current assets	**23.71**	**25.66**	**31.42**	**31.74**	**32.10**	**32.53**	**33.05**
Inventories	16.36	24.18	26.55	46.64	63.89	83.70	104.62
Trade receivables	5.44	5.56	10.82	14.78	20.25	26.52	33.15
Prepayments and other receivables	5.70	13.17	6.79	17.54	23.93	31.28	39.03
Cash and	10.79	4.93	4.71	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00

₦bn	2023A	2024A	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
cash equivalents							
Total current assets	**38.28**	**47.83**	**48.86**	**80.95**	**110.07**	**143.49**	**178.81**
Total assets	**61.99**	**73.49**	**80.29**	**112.69**	**142.17**	**176.02**	**211.86**
Total equity	19.29	22.35	30.20	40.48	55.86	77.49	105.93
of which retained earnings	13.31	16.36	23.98	34.26	49.65	71.27	99.71
Borrowings (non-current)	17.77	16.00	14.00	15.14	14.15	13.30	13.06
Other non-current liabilities	4.13	5.37	5.47	5.47	5.19	5.38	5.35
Trade payables	7.05	8.58	4.45	15.51	21.25	27.83	34.79
Other payables and income tax payable	2.97	4.28	6.51	6.51	6.51	6.51	6.51
Bank overdraft	0.78	1.28	0.01	4.38	8.94	10.38	5.92
Other financial liabilities	10.00	15.65	19.65	25.19	30.26	35.13	40.29
Total liabilities	**42.70**	**51.15**	**50.09**	**72.21**	**86.30**	**98.53**	**105.93**

₦bn	2023A	2024A	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
Total equity and liabilities	**61.99**	**73.49**	**80.29**	**112.69**	**142.17**	**176.02**	**211.86**

- Total assets grow from ₦80.3bn to ₦211.9bn, driven by working capital (inventories, receivables and prepayments) rather than fixed assets. PPE stays near ₦31bn to ₦32bn.
- Cash is held at the ₦2.0bn minimum in every forecast year, and the overdraft is the balancing item.
- Funded debt (borrowings, other financial liabilities and overdraft) rises from ₦33.7bn in FY2025 to ₦59.3bn in FY2029F. Equity rises to 50% of total assets as retained earnings build.
- The model balances in every year (balance check of zero in all periods).

8.4 Cash Flow Statement, FY2026F to FY2029F

₦bn	**2026F**	**2027F**	**2028F**	**2029F**
EBIT	36.85	51.16	67.46	84.42
Add: depreciation and amortisation	3.12	3.60	4.28	5.25
EBITDA	**39.97**	**54.76**	**71.74**	**89.67**
Change in working capital	(23.74)	(23.66)	(26.65)	(28.38)
Net exchange loss	(5.73)	(5.73)	(5.73)	(5.73)
Impairment of receivables	(0.22)	(0.22)	(0.22)	(0.22)
Finance income	0.18	0.08	0.08	0.08
Finance cost	(7.29)	(9.68)	(11.55)	(12.73)
Taxation	(9.14)	(13.68)	(19.22)	(25.28)
Cash flow from operations	**(5.96)**	**1.87**	**8.44**	**17.40**
Capital expenditure (PPE and intangibles)	(3.44)	(3.96)	(4.71)	(5.78)
Free cash flow (operations less capex)	**(9.40)**	**(2.09)**	**3.74**	**11.62**

₦bn	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
Dividends paid	(4.37)	(6.54)	(9.19)	(12.09)
Net new loans and other financial liabilities	6.68	4.08	4.02	4.93
Net draw / (repayment) of overdraft	4.38	4.56	1.44	(4.46)
Cash flow from financing	**6.69**	**2.09**	**(3.74)**	**(11.62)**
Net change in cash	(2.71)	0.00	0.00	0.00
Closing cash	2.00	2.00	2.00	2.00

- Working capital absorbs ₦23.7bn to ₦28.4bn a year. Cash from operations is negative in FY2026F and reaches only 19% of EBITDA by FY2029F (cash conversion of about -15%, 3%, 12% and 19% over the four years).
- Free cash flow is negative in FY2026F and FY2027F, so growth and dividends are funded by borrowing in the early years. Net new borrowing including the overdraft falls from ₦11.1bn in FY2026F to about ₦0.5bn in FY2029F as profits build.
- Capital expenditure is light (₦3.4bn to ₦5.8bn a year), so investing activity is a minor use of cash and the business is modelled as not capital intensive.

8.5 Key Ratios

Metric	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
Working capital (₦bn)	18.25	29.35	43.11	63.64	91.29
Current ratio (model classification)	1.60x	1.57x	1.64x	1.80x	2.04x
Equity / total assets	37.6%	35.9%	39.3%	44.0%	50.0%
Total liabilities / equity	1.66x	1.78x	1.55x	1.27x	1.00x
Net debt / EBITDA	0.95x	1.07x	0.94x	0.79x	0.64x
Interest	3.9x	5.1x	5.3x	5.8x	6.6x

Metric	2025A	2026F	2027F	2028F	2029F
coverage (EBIT / finance cost)					
Return on equity	32.7%	36.2%	39.3%	39.8%	38.3%
Return on assets	12.3%	13.0%	15.4%	17.5%	19.1%
Cash from operations / EBITDA	n/a	-14.9%	3.4%	11.8%	19.4%

Working capital is total current assets less total current liabilities. Net debt is borrowings, other financial liabilities and overdraft less cash.

8.6 Scenario Analysis

The model flexes four drivers across three cases for FY2026F to FY2029F.

Driver	Base case	Best case	Worst case
Revenue growth (2026F to 2029F)	43.6%, 37%, 31%, 25%	48.6%, 42%, 36%, 30%	38.6%, 32%, 26%, 20%
Cost of sales (% of revenue)	55.4%	50.4%	60.4%
Selling and distribution (% of revenue)	9.4%	7.4%	11.4%
Administrative (% of revenue)	12.6%	7.6%	17.6%

Recalculating the model under each case gives the following outcomes.

Outcome	Base case	Best case	Worst case
FY2029F revenue (₦bn)	383.4	444.1	329.3
FY2029F EBITDA (₦bn)	89.7	157.1	37.5
FY2029F EBITDA margin	23.4%	35.4%	11.4%
FY2026F profit for the year (₦bn)	14.7	28.6	1.6
FY2029F profit for the	40.5	84.0	4.4

Outcome	Base case	Best case	Worst case
year (₦bn)			
FY2029F return on equity	38.3%	45.8%	11.3%
FY2029F interest coverage	6.6x	14.5x	1.7x
FY2029F current ratio	2.04x	3.03x	1.18x
Cumulative cash from operations, FY2026F to FY2029F (₦bn)	21.8	110.6	(54.3)
FY2029F bank overdraft (₦bn)	5.9	nil	53.4

The cases move margins far more than growth: the combined cost assumptions swing the EBITDA margin by about 12 points either way, from 11.4% to 35.4% against 25.5% in FY2025. The best case therefore assumes a margin with no historical precedent at Fidson, while the worst case assumes a sharp one-year margin collapse. In the worst case profit stays barely positive, interest cover falls to about 1.7x, operating cash flow is negative in every year, and the overdraft would exceed ₦50bn, so liquidity rather than profitability becomes the binding constraint.

8.7 Model Limitations: How to Read the Forecast

1. **Restructured presentation.** EBIT excludes the net exchange loss and impairment, so it is ₦6.1bn above audited operating profit in FY2025. All borrowings are shown as non-current, so the model's current ratio (1.6x in FY2025) is about 1.2x on the audited classification. Compare the model with the annual report on a like-for-like basis.
2. **Exchange loss held flat.** The net exchange loss is held at ₦5.7bn while revenue triples, which flatters the net margin. At its FY2025 share of revenue (about 5.0%) the loss would be nearer ₦19bn in FY2029F. The loss depends on foreign-currency exposure rather than sales, so this is illustrative, but it shows the sensitivity.
3. **Working-capital reset.** Working-capital ratios revert to three-year averages in FY2026F: inventory 27.3% of revenue (22.3% in FY2025) and trade payables 16.4% of cost of sales (6.7% in FY2025). The net result is the ₦23.7bn outflow and negative operating cash flow in FY2026F. Using FY2025 ratios or a glide path would change the early-year cash profile materially.
4. **Intangible amortisation.** The driver sets amortisation at 440% of the opening intangible balance, so amortisation rises from ₦0.29bn in FY2025 to ₦1.05bn in FY2026F and ₦3.14bn in FY2029F, with intangible capex of ₦3.45bn by FY2029F against a balance of about ₦1bn. This slightly lowers EBIT and cash, and the driver should be redesigned (for example as a share of revenue).
5. **Growth is an assumption, not a build.** Revenue growth is the historical average stepped down over time, not a volume and price build. PPE stays near ₦31bn to ₦32bn while revenue triples and capex is only about ₦2.3bn a year, so the forecast is consistent only if growth is largely price-led or there is spare capacity.

6. **Effective tax.** The forecast uses 38.4%, the historical average effective rate, which is above the statutory rate and should be reviewed against the new tax regime.

9. Catalysts and Growth Opportunities

This section identifies company-specific drivers, split into near-term catalysts (plausible within 6 to 12 months) and long-term growth opportunities (structural, multi-year), and sizes the most significant one using the team's financial model.

9.1 Near-Term Catalysts (6 to 12 months)

- **Product pipeline.** After Endotone (2025) and Atropine 1% w/v Eye Drops (April 2026), further launches within existing therapeutic categories would add revenue without new capex, given Fidson's multi-dosage-form manufacturing base.
- **Export growth.** Export revenue reached about ₦1.82bn in Q1 2026 compared with ₦523m for the whole of 2025. Continued growth would begin to diversify a revenue base that is 99.6% Nigerian.
- **Leadership signals.** Section 7.7 treats the 2025 CEO transition as an execution risk. The catalyst to watch is whether Mr. Biola Adebayo's capital-allocation and strategy statements, for example with FY2026 results, signal more assertive export or capacity plans. This should be tracked as evidence emerges, not assumed.

9.2 Long-Term Growth Opportunities (multi-year)

- **Public health and donor-funded procurement.** According to the company's profile, Fidson was the first sub-Saharan African manufacturer of antiretroviral drugs (2005). That positions it as a credible supplier to government and donor-funded programmes, a more stable, tender-based source of demand than open-market retail sales and a partial offset to the affordability risk in Section 7.2.
- **Manufacturing capacity expansion.** Fidson's growth has historically been capacity-led. The quantified case is in Section 9.3.
- **Export, toll manufacturing and local-manufacturing policy.** These tailwinds are covered in Sections 4 and 5 and are not repeated here.

9.3 Quantifying the Lead Catalyst: Capacity Expansion

Rather than assert that capacity expansion is a catalyst, the chain below sizes it against the team's base case: capacity → volume → revenue → EBITDA → free cash flow → value.

Capacity and volume. The 2016 plant investment (about ₦10bn) more than doubled capacity. The base case takes revenue from ₦119.06bn to ₦383.44bn by FY2029F (3.2x), yet PPE stays near ₦31bn to ₦32bn and PPE capex is only about ₦2.3bn a year. Whether capacity is a binding constraint therefore depends on how much of the growth is price and how much is volume, and the model does not separate the two. As an illustration only: if prices rose 30% a year, in line with the 30.35% healthcare inflation seen in early 2026, the base-case growth rates of 43.6%, 37%, 31% and 25% would imply volume growth of roughly 10%, 5%, 1% and -4%. That is consistent with modest capex. If price increases were nearer 10% a year, the volume growth required would be roughly 31%, 25%, 19% and 14%, and a further capacity cycle would be needed.

Revenue to EBITDA. The base case holds the EBITDA margin flat at 23.4%, so it assumes no operating leverage from growth. Incremental volume through fixed manufacturing infrastructure could produce higher operating leverage, which is the upside the best case (35.4% EBITDA margin) represents, but that margin is an input to the model and not an output of any capacity assumption.

EBITDA to free cash flow. Free cash flow is negative in FY2026F (₦-9.4bn) and FY2027F (₦-2.1bn) because working capital absorbs more than ₦23bn a year. A capacity investment would add capex on top, so the net effect on cash and value depends on its size and timing relative to the EBITDA it generates. This must be modelled explicitly in the valuation work (Section 10).

Bottom line. Capacity expansion is a conditional rather than a proven constraint on the growth case. The team should build a price-and-volume revenue forecast to show what physical output the plan requires.

9.4 Financial Model Trajectory

The base case projects revenue rising from ₦119.06bn in FY2025 to ₦383.44bn in FY2029F with the gross margin held at 44.6% and the EBITDA margin at 23.4%. Two caveats apply and should be stated openly:

- Revenue growth is a stepped-down historical average (43.6% falling to 25%), not a volume-and-price build, so it is a modelling simplification and not a forecast grounded in the catalysts above.
- Profit growth beyond revenue growth comes from below-EBIT items (a flat exchange loss and slower-growing finance costs), which should be tested against the FX and interest-rate scenarios in Section 7.

9.5 Summary

Fidson's growth case rests on a few trackable near-term signals (product launches, export growth, early leadership signals) layered on longer-term structural opportunities (donor and institutional procurement, capacity-led expansion, export and policy tailwinds). Capacity expansion is the one most directly tied to the model's growth assumption, and the evidence needed to judge it is a price-and-volume split.

10. Valuation and Recommendation

Status. This version of the report does not contain a valuation. The financial model has no discounted cash flow or multiples sheet, so the report gives **no rating and no target price**. Any rating should wait until the valuation is complete and documented.

What the valuation needs.

- The share price at a stated valuation date, and the number of shares in issue.
- A discount rate (cost of equity and WACC) built from a Nigerian risk-free rate, an equity risk premium and a beta, with the sources shown.
- Free cash flows from the model. Because free cash flow is negative in FY2026F and FY2027F, most of the value will sit in the terminal period, so results must be shown against a range of discount rates and terminal growth rates.

- A peer comparison on P/E and EV/EBITDA against May & Baker, Neimeth, MeCure and other listed pharmaceutical companies.
- A probability-weighted value across the base, best and worst cases in Section 8.6.

Preliminary assessment. Fidson has a positive long-term growth outlook, supported by a diversified portfolio, established local manufacturing capability, policy support for import substitution and a record of growing despite FX pressure. The risks are equally clear: foreign exchange volatility, margin sustainability, weak cash conversion while working capital builds, and concentration in the Nigerian market. The scenario range for FY2029F profit after tax of ₦4.4bn to ₦84.0bn shows that value depends mainly on the margin outcome, so a recommendation should rest on a probability-weighted view of the scenarios and not on revenue growth alone.

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